



Vizag Open golf: Angad Cheema wins playoff against Aman Raj

Chandigarh golfer Angad Cheema capped off a season of remarkable consistency by holding his nerve in a playoff to claim his second PGTI title at the Vizag Open, ending an 11-year title drought. Cheema edged out Aman Raj of Patna at the East Point Golf Club after a gripping final round.

Angad, who led by three strokes overnight with rounds of 69, 61, and 70, carded a solid three-under 68 in the final round, bringing his total to 16-under 268. However, a series of birdies by Aman (66, 68, 69, 65) resulted in a six-under 65 — the best score of the day — bringing him level with Angad and forcing a playoff.

In the playoff, Angad sank a crucial eight-foot birdie putt to secure the win and take home a cheque worth Rs 15 lakh. The victory also propelled him from fourth to third place in the TATA Steel PGTI Rankings, marking a well-deserved reward after six top-10 finishes this season, including two runner-up spots.

Bengaluru's Aryan Roopa Anand (67) and Gurugram's Kartik Sharma (70) finished a distant tied third at a total of 10-under 274.

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1 Wrestling Federation of India (WFI) president Sanjay Singh announced that no Indian team will be fielded for the World Championships unless the Union Sports Ministry revokes its decision to de-recognise the national body. "We will not send any team to the World Championships. The problem is due to the Government's de-recognition (of an elected WFI on December 24). I will write to the UWW stating that because of Government interference, we are not able to send a team, as doing so will result in contempt of court," Sanjay Singh told *Sportstar*. "It's not good for our wrestlers, who have been performing so well."

Y. B. SARANGI

2 The Kho Kho Federation of India (KKFI) and the International Kho Kho Federation have announced that India will host the inaugural Kho Kho World Cup in 2025. The historic event will feature 24 countries from six continents, with 16 men's and 16 women's teams competing. With its origins deeply rooted in India, Kho Kho has evolved from being played on mud to modern mats, gaining international recognition. Today, the sport is played in 54 countries, and the World Cup will celebrate both its rich cultural heritage and the competitive spirit that has driven its global expansion.

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